Errata

On Coppock, Ekins and Kirby (2018), *Quarterly Journal of Political Science* 13(1)

This note lists eighteen corrections to "The Long-lasting Effects of Newspaper Op-Eds on Public Opinion," published in the *Quarterly Journal of Political Science* 13(1), doi 10.1561/100.00016112. **None of them changes a conclusion of the paper.** The first seven are sentences in the body text that disagree with a table the same article prints, and in each case the table is right and the sentence is not. The next five are errors in how the article cites and lists its references, and the last six are misprints found when the article was re-typeset. The tables' estimates, and the findings they carry, are unaffected.

Every number in a corrected sentence below is computed from the deposited replication archive (10.7910/DVN/3KBCJF) at the time this document is rendered, including the numbers that were not wrong. The code and output supporting each correction are at github.com/active-maintenance-aec/coppock_ekins_kirby_2018.

Bold marks what changed. The first three entries are substantive: a comparison that reverses direction on one of four op-eds, a significance level overstated by an order of magnitude, and a miscount of the cells of a table. Entries 4 through 7 are undercounted sample sizes, each of which the adjacent table gives correctly.

1. The elite sample did not read for 25 to 45 seconds less

> On average, our elite sample spent 25–45 seconds less time reading our treatment articles than the MTurk sample.

Corrected:

> On average, our elite sample spent **17.4** seconds less time reading our treatment articles than the MTurk sample.

Across the four op-eds both samples saw, the elite deficit in trimmed mean reading time is 45.6 seconds on the flat tax piece, 28.5 seconds on the Wall Street piece and 26.4 seconds on the Amtrak piece, and on the veterans piece the elite sample spent 30.7 seconds **more**, not less. The published range brackets the two arms the deposit's `opeds_compliance.R` computes, the Amtrak and flat tax pieces; the two it does not compute are the ones that break the range.

2. The elite main-effect significance level

> Turning first to main dependent variables, we found statistically significant treatment effects for three of the four treatments (Amtrak, Flat Tax, Wall Street) at $p < 0.001$, but did not for the Veterans op-ed treatment.

Corrected:

> Turning first to main dependent variables, we found statistically significant treatment effects for three of the four treatments (Amtrak, Flat Tax, Wall Street) at $p < \mathbf{0.01}$, but did not for the Veterans op-ed treatment.

The flat tax effect on its main dependent variable has $p = 0.0042$. Table 6 prints it as `0.411***` under a legend whose strongest level is $p < 0.01$, so the table and the sentence disagree about the same estimate. The Amtrak and Wall Street effects are significant at 0.001; the flat tax effect is not. The cell is also the article's only significant evidence of a flat tax effect among elites: on its composite scale (Table 7) the effect is 0.104 with $p = 0.136$, as p. 74 says. It clears 0.01, so the sentence's count stands, and so does p. 73's claim of significant effects for each of the four op-eds, each on at least one of its two target measures. H3's expectation of smaller effects among elites does not rest on this cell: Table 8 tests it on the composite scales, where the flat tax interaction is –0.384 ($p < 0.001$).

3. Table 7 has twelve non-target cells, not sixteen

> Of the 16 treatment effects on non-target issues, only one is statistically significant (Amtrak op-ed on Veterans outcome).

Corrected:

> Of the **12** treatment effects on non-target issues, only one is statistically significant (Amtrak op-ed on Veterans outcome).

Table 7 estimates four op-ed effects on each of four composite scales, so it holds 16 coefficients, of which four are on target and 12 are not. The parallel sentence about Table 3 counts correctly: five op-eds by five outcomes is 25 coefficients and 20 non-target ones. One significant effect in 12 rather than one in 16 is still what chance gives: 12 null effects tested at 0.05 produce 0.6 significant ones in expectation, and at least one with probability 0.46 if they are independent, so the preceding sentence's "all close to zero" stands.

4. The number of elite subjects who completed the survey

> This procedure yielded 2,169 subjects who completed our survey.

Corrected:

> This procedure yielded **2,181** subjects who completed our survey.

Table 5, at the top of the same page, gives 2,181 as its own total, and that is the number of rows in the deposited elite data. Tables 6 and 7 report the same figure as their N.

5. The number of elite subjects who responded in Wave 2

> As in the MTurk study, we asked subjects to participate in a follow-up survey after 10 days; after two reminders, we obtained 1,349 complete responses.

Corrected:

> As in the MTurk study, we asked subjects to participate in a follow-up survey after 10 days; after two reminders, we obtained **1,358** complete responses.

Table 5's Responded row totals 1,358.

6. The number of subjects enrolled on Mechanical Turk

> We enrolled 3,567 subjects on Amazon's Mechanical Turk (MTurk) in a three-wave panel survey.

Corrected:

> We enrolled **3,571** subjects on Amazon's Mechanical Turk (MTurk) in a three-wave panel survey.

Table 1 gives 3,571 as its own total, and every column of Tables 3 and 4 reports the same figure as its N.

7. The range of average treatment effects reported in the Discussion

> In both studies of the mass public and elites, we find large, statistically significant average treatment effects of op-eds between 0.30 and 0.50 standard deviations on policy attitudes.

Corrected:

> In both studies of the mass public and elites, we find large, statistically significant average treatment effects of op-eds between **0.28 and 0.52** standard deviations on policy attitudes.

The sentence pairs one figure with each study, so the two numbers are the study-level means over the on-target composite scales: 0.283 across the 4 elite op-eds and 0.522 across the 5 on Mechanical Turk. Neither figure is hedged, so the interval is asserted as printed, and both means fall outside it. The individual effects run wider still, from 0.104 to 0.698. The correction widens the gap H3 predicts: the elite mean is 54 percent of the Mechanical Turk mean, where the printed endpoints give 60, and over the 4 op-eds both samples saw the Mechanical Turk mean is 0.583, so like for like the elite effect is 48 percent of it. The abstract's "marginally more persuasive among the mass public" understates either range, and Table 8's interactions are the article's test of the comparison. One of the four elite effects in the mean, flat tax, is not significant on its own ($p = 0.136$).

The reference list

The five entries below correct the article's reference list and the in-text citations that repeat its errors. Entries 8 to 10 were found by an audit that sends every printed entry whole to Crossref and checks the authoritative record back into it, and entries 11 and 12 when the article was re-typeset; each is verified against the record named in its note. No cited work is missing and no citation in the text points at the wrong work: what is wrong is how the article prints the authors. Bold marks what changed, and an error repeated in several places is quoted in each of them.

8. Traverso is misspelled, in the reference list and in the text

Published, pp. 61, 63 and 84:

> (Ciofalo and **Traveso**, 1994)
>
> As Ciofalo and **Traveso** (1994) note
>
> Ciofalo, A. and K. **Traveso**. 1994.

Corrected:

> (Ciofalo and **Traverso**, 1994)
>
> As Ciofalo and **Traverso** (1994) note
>
> Ciofalo, A. and K. **Traverso**. 1994.

Crossref, doi 10.1177/073953299401500407: Ciofalo, Andrew, and Kim Traverso. The misspelling is in both in-text citations, on pp. 61 and 63, and in the entry.

9. Calavita and Krumholz (2003) is printed as one author, filed under his given name

Published, pp. 60 and 86:

> (Alexander, 2004; Golan, 2013; **Nico Calavita**, 2003; Rosenfeld, 2000
>
> **Nico Calavita, N. K.** 2003.

Corrected:

> (Alexander, 2004; Golan, 2013; **Calavita and Krumholz**, 2003; Rosenfeld, 2000
>
> **Calavita, N. and N. Krumholz.** 2003.

Crossref, doi 10.1177/0739456x03022004006: Calavita, Nico, and Norman Krumholz. The first author's given name was taken as part of his surname and the second author's initials were folded onto it, leaving one author where there are two, in the entry and in the in-text citation on p. 60.

10. Two authors of Page, Shapiro and Dempsey (1987) are given by their given names

Published, p. 86:

> Page, B. I., **Y. S. Robert, and D. Glenn**. 1987. "What Moves Public Opinion?" American Political Science Review **81**.

Corrected:

> Page, B. I., R. Y. Shapiro, and G. R. Dempsey. 1987. "What Moves Public Opinion?" American Political Science Review 81(1): 23–43.

Crossref, doi 10.2307/1960777: Page, Benjamin I., Robert Y. Shapiro and Glenn R. Dempsey, American Political Science Review 81(1): 23–43. Robert Shapiro's and Glenn Dempsey's given names were taken for their surnames, and the entry breaks off after the volume number. The in-text citation on p. 63 gives "Page et al. (1987)" correctly.

11. Vavreck (2007) is single-authored and is cited as "Vavreck et al."

Published, pp. 63 and 87:

> (Vavreck **et al.**, 2007)
>
> **Vavreck et al., L.** 2007.

Corrected:

(Vavreck, 2007)

Vavreck, L. 2007.

Crossref, doi 10.1561/100.00006005: Vavreck, Lynn, "The Exaggerated Effects of Advertising on Turnout: The Dangers of Self-Reports," Quarterly Journal of Political Science 2(4): 325–343. Lynn Vavreck is the sole author.

12. W. Russell Neuman's surname is misspelled, in the text and in the reference list

Published, pp. 64 and 86:

In their book, **Neumann** et al. (1992)

Neumann, W. R., M. R. Just, and A. N. Crigler. 1992.

Corrected:

In their book, **Neuman** et al. (1992)

Neuman, W. R., M. R. Just, and A. N. Crigler. 1992.

Crossref, doi 10.7208/chicago/9780226161174.001.0001: Neuman, W. Russell, Marion R. Just and Ann N. Crigler, Common Knowledge: News and the Construction of Political Meaning (University of Chicago Press, 1992).

Misprints

The six entries below were found when the article was re-typeset, a pass that reads every word of the published page against the text carried across. They are a doubled word, a misspelling, two disagreements of number, a table that does not label a block of its rows, and a doubled row label. None affects an estimate. Bold marks what changed.

13. A doubled "the"

Published, p. 60:

while avoiding the **the** inaccessibilities of elitism

Corrected:

while avoiding the inaccessibilities of elitism

The article sets the word twice.

14. “Op-eds” is misspelled “op-ends”

Published, p. 78:

> To measure the lasting effects of newspaper **op-ends**, we measured outcomes

Corrected:

> To measure the lasting effects of newspaper **op-eds**, we measured outcomes

The article spells the word op-eds everywhere else.

15. A singular article with a plural noun in footnote 10

Published, p. 78, footnote 10:

> appear to experience a similar **patterns** of decay.

Corrected:

> appear to experience a similar **pattern** of decay.

The article reads “a similar patterns”.

16. A plural noun with a singular verb in the description of Table 10

Published, p. 80:

> The first **columns** shows the total circulation

Corrected:

> The first **column** shows the total circulation

The sentence describes one column of Table 10, and the next sentence describes the second.

17. Table 5 does not label its Wave 2 rows

Published, p. 72, Table 5:

> Table 5: Distraction | No distraction | Responded | Did not respond

Corrected:

> Table 5: **Wave 2** | Distraction | No distraction | Responded | Did not respond

Table 5 sets its four recontact rows directly under the Wave 1 header row, with no label and no indent, so they read as Wave 1 counts. Table 1 labels the same rows “Wave 2” for the Mechanical Turk study and indents them. The counts are right; the label is restored.

18. The intercept row of five regression tables is labelled "Constant (Constant)"

Published, pp. 70, 71, 73, 74 and 75, Tables 3, 4, 6, 7 and 8:

Constant (Constant)

Corrected:

Constant

The label is doubled in all five tables. No estimate is affected.